

12. Sentences

Definition

A sentence is a group of words that makes complete sense and expresses a complete thought. It always begins with a capital letter and ends with a full stop, a question mark, or an exclamation mark. Every sentence must be meaningful on its own. Each sentence has two essential parts called the subject and the predicate. Understanding sentences is the foundation of correct grammar.

The boy plays in the park.

She reads a book.

They are going to school.

The sun rises in the east.

We love our country.

Declarative or Assertive Sentence

A declarative or assertive sentence states a fact, opinion, or idea clearly. It is used to give information to the reader or listener. Such sentences are commonly used in statements and descriptions. They always end with a full stop. Most sentences used in everyday language are declarative.

I live in Delhi.

She likes music.

The sky is blue.

He is my friend.

We respect our teachers.

Interrogative Sentence

An interrogative sentence is used to ask a question and seek information. It often begins with a helping verb or a question word. Such sentences are common in conversations. They always end with a question mark. Interrogative sentences help us gather information.

What is your name?

Where are you going?

Is he your brother?

Did you finish your homework?

Why are you late?

Imperative Sentence

An imperative sentence gives an order, request, advice, or suggestion. The subject 'you' is usually hidden in such sentences. Imperative sentences may end with a full stop or an exclamation mark. They are commonly used in instructions. The tone of an imperative sentence depends on its purpose.

Close the door.

Please help me.

Do your homework.

Always speak the truth.

Be careful.

Exclamatory Sentence

An exclamatory sentence expresses strong feelings such as joy, surprise, anger, or sorrow. It shows emotion rather than simple information. Such sentences are often sudden reactions. They always end with an exclamation mark. Exclamatory sentences add emotion to language.

What a beautiful flower!

How brave he is!

Alas! We lost the match!

Wow! That was amazing!

Oh no! I forgot my bag!

Simple Sentence

A simple sentence has one subject and one predicate only. It expresses a single complete idea. Simple sentences do not contain subordinate clauses. They are easy to understand. Such sentences are used in basic communication.

I read books.

She sings well.

He runs fast.

We are happy.

The child laughed.

Compound Sentence

A compound sentence contains two or more independent clauses. These clauses are joined by coordinating conjunctions. Each clause can stand alone as a sentence.

Compound sentences show a relationship between ideas. They help combine related thoughts.

I called him and he came.

She worked hard but failed.

He was tired yet he continued.

I wanted to go but it rained.

She studied so she passed.

Complex Sentence

A complex sentence has one main clause and one or more subordinate clauses. The subordinate clause depends on the main clause for meaning. Complex sentences show time, cause, or condition. They add detail to the main idea. Such sentences are common in formal writing.

I know that he is honest.

She stayed home because she was ill.

When it rained, we stopped.

He told me where he lived.

I will go if you come.

Compound-Complex Sentence

A compound-complex sentence contains two or more main clauses and at least one subordinate clause. It combines features of compound and complex sentences. Such sentences express detailed relationships between ideas. They are usually longer. Correct punctuation is important in these sentences.

I called him and he came when I asked.

She was tired but she worked because it was urgent.

He finished work and he left after sunset.

We waited and we left when it got late.

She sang and danced although she was tired.

Affirmative Sentence

An affirmative sentence states something positively. It tells what is or what happens. Such sentences do not contain negative words. They confirm an action or a state. Affirmative sentences are common in statements.

She likes music.

We are ready.

He plays cricket.

They live here.

I believe you.

Negative Sentence

A negative sentence states something in the negative form. It usually uses words like not, never, or no. Negative sentences deny an action or fact. They show refusal or absence. Correct use of negatives is important in grammar.

She does not like tea.

We are not late.

He never lies.

They did not come.

I cannot help you.

Interrogative-Negative Sentence

An interrogative-negative sentence is both a question and negative in meaning. It asks a question in a negative form. Such sentences often express surprise or confirmation. They always end with a question mark. They are common in spoken English.

Don't you like apples?

Isn't he coming today?

Can't you help me?

Didn't she call you?

Won't they agree?

EXERCISES

Identify the type of sentence

1. Question.
2. Question.
3. Question.
4. Question.
5. Question.
6. Question.
7. Question.
8. Question.
9. Question.
10. Question.

Change sentences as directed

1. Question.
2. Question.
3. Question.
4. Question.
5. Question.
6. Question.
7. Question.
8. Question.
9. Question.
10. Question.

Fill in the blanks

1. Question.
2. Question.
3. Question.
4. Question.
5. Question.
6. Question.

7. Question.
8. Question.
9. Question.
10. Question.

Rewrite sentences

1. Question.
2. Question.
3. Question.
4. Question.
5. Question.

Identify subject and predicate

1. Question.
2. Question.
3. Question.
4. Question.
5. Question.

ANSWER SHEET

Identify the type of sentence

1. Answer.
2. Answer.
3. Answer.
4. Answer.
5. Answer.
6. Answer.
7. Answer.
8. Answer.
9. Answer.
10. Answer.

Change sentences as directed

1. Answer.
2. Answer.
3. Answer.
4. Answer.
5. Answer.
6. Answer.
7. Answer.
8. Answer.
9. Answer.
10. Answer.

Fill in the blanks

1. Answer.
2. Answer.
3. Answer.
4. Answer.
5. Answer.
6. Answer.

7. Answer.
8. Answer.
9. Answer.
10. Answer.

Rewrite sentences

1. Answer.
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Identify subject and predicate

1. Answer.
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4. Answer.
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